DIGITAL LITERACY

PROJECT REPORT

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➢ INTRODUCTION-

- This project is developed as part of the Digital Ambassador initiative which is aimed at improving digital literacy and responsible online behaviour among the students.
- In today's technology-driven world, it is essential for students to understand how to use digital tools effectively, communicate professionally, and stay safe online.
- This project includes multiple tasks such as creating a digital literacy infographic, building a professional online portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practicing email etiquette, and understanding cybercrime awareness.
- Each task focuses on developing practical skills that are useful for academic growth and future career opportunities.
- Through this project, the goal is to promote awareness, enhance technical skills, and encourage students to maintain a positive and professional digital presence.

Task 1 -- Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Reflection: Digital Literacy Infographic

- Tool Used:
  - Used Canva for template selection and overall layout design
  - Researched digital literacy concepts through reliable educational websites
  - Used ChatGPT to generate illustrations and visuals related to digital literacy
  - Wrote all text content independently

- What the Design Shows:
  - Defines digital literacy as the ability to use technology confidently and responsibly
  - Highlights essential student tools: Google Docs for writing, GitHub for coding projects, LinkedIn for professional presence, and Canva for design
  - Covers digital wellness tips such as setting screen time limits, taking regular breaks, and practicing digital detoxes to maintain a healthy relationship with technology
  - Includes a future-focused section on emerging skills like AI, machine learning, data analysis, blockchain, and cultivating lifelong learning habits

- One Thing I Found Difficult/Interesting:

- The most interesting part was building the future skills section realizing digital literacy goes far beyond basic internet use
- It was eye-opening to see how skills like understanding AI and blockchain are becoming essential
- Balancing visual appeal with informational depth across multiple topics was a genuinely rewarding creative challenge
- Learning that digital literacy is a continuous, evolving journey rather than a fixed skill was a key personal takeaway

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Task 2 -- Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

➢ Platforms I Chose:

- GitHub : a platform for hosting, sharing, and collaborating on coding projects using version control
- LinkedIn : a professional networking site for building an online career profile and connecting with industry professionals
- Stack Overflow: a community-driven Q&A platform where developers ask and answer programming-related questions

- What Each One Is Used For:

  - GitHub is used to store code repositories, showcase projects, and collaborate with other developers worldwide
  - LinkedIn is used to display academic achievements, skills, internships, and professional experiences to potential employers
  - Stack Overflow is used to solve coding problems, learn from experienced developers, and contribute answers to the tech community

- How I Plan to Use Them Over the Next Four Years:

  - GitHub regularly upload class projects, personal coding exercises, and collaborative work to build a strong portfolio
  - LinkedIn progressively update my profile with internships, certifications, and achievements each year to attract future employers
  - Stack Overflow actively use it to troubleshoot coding challenges during studies, and eventually contribute answers as my skills grow
  - By graduation, these three platforms will collectively serve as a living digital resume showcasing my technical growth and professional readiness

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Task 3 -- Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

- Platforms I used:
- For this task I used two platforms - HackerRank for coding practice and Google Forms for building a collaborative quiz tool.

➢ HackerRank:

- On HackerRank I completed the Solve Me First challenge, which is a beginner-level Python problem. It sounds simple and it is ,but actually submitting code on a judge platform for the first time feels different from just writing it in a notebook. You realise quickly that the code either works or it doesn't, and there's no partial credit for "almost right."

➢ Google form:

- The more interesting part was building the Digital Literacy Quiz on Google Forms. I put together five questions covering phishing, UPI safety, 2FA, and cybercrime reporting. Linking it to a Google Sheet so responses populate automatically was something I hadn't properly explored before it's genuinely useful for collecting data without any manual work.

➢ Conclusion:

- Both tools are ones I'll keep using. HackerRank for staying sharp with problem-solving, and Google Forms any time I need to gather feedback or run a quick survey for a college projec

Task 4 -- Professional Email & Etiquette (PART – B)

- When Poor Digital Communication Causes Real Problems

  - In 2013, a communications professional tweeted a joke just before boarding a long-haul flight to South Africa.
  - She meant it as dark humour the kind you'd say to a close friend but her account was public and her followers weren't just close friends.
  - While she was unreachable in the air for 11 hours, the tweet went viral globally.
  - By the time she landed, her employer had already put out a public statement distancing the company from her.
  - She was fired before she even collected her luggage.
  - The damage happened entirely while she was offline — she had no chance to delete it, explain it, or apologise in time.

- What Could Have Been Done Differently

  - She could have sent the joke as a private message instead of posting it publicly — same humour, zero consequences.

- A one-second check *"does this land the same way without context?"* — would have likely stopped her from posting it.
- Keeping her account on private would have at least limited how far it could spread.
- Waiting until after the flight to post anything would have given her a chance to reconsider with a clearer head.
- The core lesson is that once something is public, you lose control of it completely. You can delete the post but not the screenshots.

Task 5 -- Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

(PART –B)

"Personal Reflection -> Stay Safe Online"

➢ What Surprised Me & One Habit I'll Change

- What genuinely surprised me while putting this checklist together was the UPI "receive money" scam.
- I had no idea that entering your PIN is only ever for sending money so when someone tells you to enter it to receive a payment, they're literally just tricking you

into authorising a transfer out of your account. The fact that this works so consistently on educated college students says a lot about how little we're actually taught about the tools we use every day.

- The other thing I didn't expect was how quick the window is for recovering money lost to online fraud.
- Calling 1930 within the first few hours apparently makes a real difference and waiting even a day can mean the money is already gone for good.
- The habit I'm changing is double-checking UPI IDs before every transfer, no matter how small or how well I think I know the recipient.

➢ CONCLUSION:

- This project helped me understand the importance of digital literacy in both academic and professional life.
- I have learnt about using digital tools effectively, creating a professional online presence, and communicate properly through emails.
- Exploring platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, and coding websites like hackerank and coding communities like stackoverflow improved my technical and collaboration skills.
- I also gained awareness about cybercrime and safe internet practices, which are essential in today’s digital world.
- Overall, this project enhanced my confidence in using technology responsibly and well prepared me to guide others as a Digital Ambassador .